

The Painted Joy

Player-facing description

The Painted Joy: Glimpsed through the thorns: a hidden village painted in bright murals and lit by glowing moss, full of color and care ? nothing like the den of thieves you were warned about.

Public role

Clue / evidence

Handout text

Player-safe note: Glimpsed through the thorns: a hidden village painted in bright murals and lit by glowing moss, full of color and care ? nothing like the den of thieves you were warned about.

GM truth

Use this element to reveal the cost of managed protection through concrete play.

GM handling

Use when players need a tangible handle on the scene's pressure.

Mechanics

- Title: Discovery / Earn-It Mechanics
- Player Safe: Players can inspect, handle, keep, trade, reveal, or earn The Painted Joy when it is present in the fiction.
- Gm Only: Use the roll only when the player's method, stakes, and consequence are concrete.
- No Roll Reveals: Surface read: Glimpsed through the thorns: a hidden village painted in bright murals and lit by glowing moss, full of color and care ? nothing like the den of thieves you were warned about. Give obvious visible facts freely; roll for meaning, risk, leverage, cost, or a hidden angle.
- Rolls: entity-the-painted-joy-engage-the-painted-joy entity-the-painted-joy Engage The Painted Joy Engage The Painted Joy Knowledge Finesse Instinct Presence Knowledge Finesse, Instinct, Presence 12 Choose the trait from the player's method, not the entity type. A flat read of The Painted Joy hides the cost, motive, or useful next step. Critical Success: best possible version of the action; gain Hope and clear 1 Stress. Add an extra benefit that follows from the fiction. Success with Hope: the PC gets what they wanted and gains Hope. Keep the position clean or generous. Success with Fear: the PC gets what they wanted, but the GM gains Fear and introduces a cost, complication, or pressure. Failure with Hope: the PC does not get the full result, but gains Hope and receives a useful thread, clue, or safer next option. Failure with Fear: the PC fails and the GM gains Fear. Make a hard move

that...

- Fear Spends: Reveal who benefits from the current situation. Make the cost personal without closing off player agency.
- Condition Options: No official condition unless the item or clue physically creates Hidden, Restrained, or Vulnerable
- Search Loot: Player-safe note: Glimpsed through the thorns: a hidden village painted in bright murals and lit by glowing moss, full of color and care ? nothing like the den of thieves you were warned about.

Profile

- Schema Version: clue-profile-v1
- Id: the-painted-joy
- Clue Id: the-painted-joy
- Clue Name: The Painted Joy
- Name: The Painted Joy
- Pronunciation: the PAYN-tid JOY
- Clue Kind: environmental
- Auto Surface: True
- Atlas Lore Note: [Atlas lore - confirm or override]
- Player Safe: The Painted Joy Glimpsed through the thorns: a hidden village painted in bright murals and lit by glowing moss, full of color and care ? nothing like the den of thieves you were warned about. Glimpsed through the thorns: a hidden village painted in bright murals and lit by glowing moss, full of color and care ? nothing like the den of thieves you were warned about. Glimpsed through the thorns: a hidden village painted in bright murals and lit by glowing moss, full of color and care ? nothing like the den of thieves you were warned about.
- Block0: the-painted-joy The Painted Joy the PAYN-tid JOY environmental
- Block1: the Bramble make beauty and community; the "criminal syndicate" framing is propaganda. HIDDEN The Bramble Truth the-bramble-truth Complicates victory over the Bramble and rewards empathy, capture, or careful interrogation. [pages/entities/the-painted-joy.html](#) [pages/clues/the-bramble-truth.html](#)
- Block2: Glimpsed through the thorns: a hidden village painted in bright murals and lit by glowing moss, full of color and care ? nothing like the den of thieves you were warned about. the Bramble make beauty and community; the "criminal syndicate" framing is propaganda.
- Block3: "there's color and music behind the thorns." "this is a real, loving community." You have enough GM-only proof that the Bramble community is real, loving, and not the criminal den the notices describe. You have enough GM-only proof that the Bramble community is real, loving, and not the criminal den the notices describe.
- Block4: The Interrogation Answer Bramble-Are-Criminals Notice the-interrogation-answer bramble-are-criminals-noticetm
- Block5: MAP-LOC-bramble-union-villages S02-04 Bramble Union Villages The Wandering Briar Bramble Union get past the thorns (rare this one-shot); a glimpse. [clues/The_Bramble_Truth.md](#)
- Block6: HIDDEN Use this clue to support The Bramble Truth: the Bramble make beauty and community; the "criminal syndicate" framing is propaganda. whisper True

- Block8: Bright, saturated storybook evidence illustration; clear hero shot of the actual clue object or scene detail; whimsical frontier-Renaissance materials; warm light; bright dystopian corporate satire when branded; no gore, no UI, no watermark, no repeated icon. Depict: a bright muraled hidden village glowing inside towering thorns. clue wiki card and Player Display evidence visual Send the image and SHOW text only. Keep TELL, points_to, and blunt ladder rungs GM-only until earned.
/Users/kyle/Documents/My Games/Peril To Profit/story-atlas/src/clue_images/the-painted-joy/profile_base.png assets/clue-images/the-painted-joy/profile_base.png
Bright, saturated storybook evidence illustration; clear hero shot of the actual clue object or scene detail; whimsical frontier-Renaissance materials; warm light; bright dystopian corporate satire when branded; no gore, no UI, no watermark, no repeated...
- Block9: Official Daggerheart action roll using Duality Dice, Hope, Fear, and Difficulty; P2P Roll Slider is the table-facing result ladder. Agility move, climb, dodge, reach a better angle, or read evidence while moving Strength lift, hold, force, carry, break, or test weight and pressure Finesse handle, hide, tinker, compare, pick apart, or notice precise detail Instinct perceive, smell, listen, track, read danger, or sense body language Presence charm, soothe, press, lead, deceive, perform, or read a social response Knowledge recall, analyze, investigate, reason from lore, or understand systems Instinct D14 Knowledge D14 Presence D14 If the clue is plainly visible, give the SHOW text freely first: Glimpsed through the thorns: a hidden village painted in bright murals and lit by glowing moss, full of color and care ? nothing like the den of thieves you were warned about. Use the listed...
- Mechanicids: duality-dice hope fear difficulty roll-slider clue-discovery
- Visual Assets: profile_base Clue evidence image /Users/kyle/Documents/My Games/Peril To Profit/story-atlas/src/clue_images/the-painted-joy/profile_base.png assets/clue-images/the-painted-joy/profile_base.png ready The Painted Joy clue image. Glimpsed through the thorns: a hidden village painted in bright murals and lit by glowing moss, full of color and care ? nothing like the den of thieves you were warned about.

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